

Healthy Family, Healthy Community

Monthly awareness sessions help families and whole communities build the everyday habits that keep people well. Use the 16 cell indicators for families and for communities to guide each session.

For health workers

Key messages

- Wash hands with soap or ash after using the toilet and before handling food.
- Use a toilet, keep water covered and clean, and dispose of rubbish safely.
- Make sure every child is fully immunised.
- Sleep under a bed net, and take pregnant women for antenatal care.

- Eat a variety of foods from the garden, and weigh children under five.
- Care for the elderly and for people with disabilities, and include them in village life.

Talk to the health facility if you see

- A child who is very thin or not growing
- Many people in a village with the same sickness
- A household with no safe drinking water
- A mother who has not been seen for antenatal care

Run a village session

1. Meet in a shaded, central place at a time when families can come. Greet everyone and say what today's topic is.
2. Ask what people already know and what they have heard. Listen first.
3. Share three key messages from this page in your local language. Use pictures and real examples from the village.

4. Ask people to say the messages back in their own words, and answer questions.
5. Agree on one action the village will take this month. Refer anyone who is unwell, and record who came.

General information only. Follow the advice of your health centre and current national guidelines.